

26FA US CS 硕士申请复盘

- 郑千惠 -
2026.07.26

GCAC
GC ADVISING CENTER

目录

1. 自我介绍: 申请时的背景
2. 申请时间线: 从标化考试到提交申请
3. School List: 如何选择校与项目定位
4. 材料准备: 标化、推荐信与文书
5. 申请结果复盘: 录取中的匹配与不确定性
6. 申请心态: 如何看待项目选择与最终结果

About Me

GPA: 机械工程 3.89/4.0 + 计算机科学 4.00/4.0

科研经历: 交大数据挖掘方向 ×1, 密大 HCI 方向 ×1

学术成果: 一篇在投, 一篇软著

实习经历: 无

助教经历: 交大计算机课程 TA ×2

标化: TOEFL 112/120, GRE 328

Offers:

- CMU MCDS (最终去向)、
- CMU MSIN (\$12,525 Scholarship)、
- UT Austin MSCS、
- Georgia Tech MSCS、
- USC MSCS、
- UIUC MCS



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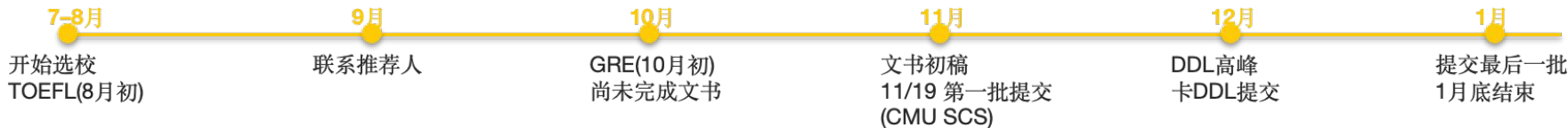
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Timeline

Ideal Timeline



My Timeline



11/1 未赶上

UPenn Priority

* Priority vs. Early (具体定义请以官网为主):

Priority 通常会提早审核, 也会更早点出结果

Early 感觉和 Regular 轮没区别, 只是Early申请费用便宜些

申请时间线: 从标化考试到提交申请

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如何选校？

1. 项目定位参考网站：
 - <https://csgrad.com/>
 - <https://opencs.app/>
2. 先分清项目定位, 而不是只看学校排名
 - 科研导向: Princeton MSECS, CMU MSR, UIUC MSCS, Yale MSCS (2yr) 等
 - 就业导向: CMU MCDS, CMU MSIN, UCB Meng, UIUC MCS 等
 - Balanced: Stanford MSCS, CMU MSCS, UT Austin MSCS, Georgia Tech MSCS 等
3. 再根据个人背景划分申请梯度
 - 彩票: Stanford MSCS, Princeton MSECS, CMU MSCS
 - 主申: CMU MCDS/MIIS/MSIN, UT-Austin MSCS, Gatech MSCS, UPenn MCIS, UCSD CS75, UCB Meng, *UCLA MSECE*
 - 保底: Columbia MSCS, UMich MSCSE, UIUC MCS, USC MSCS

Takeaway: **匹配度 > “看起来录取率更高”**

整理一个 Spreadsheet 管理进度

School	Deadline	Progress	Program	Address	Program Website	Recommendation Letter Requirements	Essay Requirements	TOEFL	GRE	CV/Resume	申请平台	Video Essay
University of Pennsylvania	Nov. 1st (Early), Feb. 1st (Regular)	Created A... Sent RL link Submitted Received a...	Master of Science in Engineering in Computer and Information Science (MSECS) ✗	Graduate Admissions Penn Engineering Philadelphia, PA 19104	https://gradadm.sas.upenn.edu/how-to-apply/	可以立刻send链接 需要在ddl前提交letter	1. Personal Statements (-2页) Why are you interested in this program? What have you done that makes you a great candidate? How will you benefit from the program? How do you plan to contribute to the student community in Penn Engineering while you're here? Why will you succeed in the program? What will you do/achieve once you have completed the program? 2. How will you explore community at Penn? Consider how Penn will help shape your perspective, and how your experiences and perspective will help shape Penn. (150-200 words)	The institution code to send your official TOEFL score report is 2888. ✓	The GRE Exam is optional for admissions to a Penn Engineering program but could have a favorable impact on your application. Institution Code: 2888 Department/Major Code: 1699 DDL前得收到才能count ✓	We are interested in your functional job skills, breadth and depth of experience, demonstrated leadership, and any experiences with online learning. We are more concerned with what you have learned in your positions than we are with the length of time you've been in the workplace. Submit your current resume in PDF or Word format. Outline your education, research experience, work experience, publications, scholarships awarded, prizes and honors received, society memberships, and extracurricular activities. Note: Links embedded into text will not be readable due to security reasons. Please list any URL that you would like the admissions committee to see at the bottom of your document.	https://gradadmissions.sas.upenn.edu/apply/?m/edu2c4b2-e8e8-4e12-8163-0f6c39d383b4	
Carnegie Mellon University	Nov. 19th (Early), Dec. 10th (Final)	Created A... Sent RL link Submitted Received a...	Master in Computer Science (MSCS) ✗	Computer Science Department Carnegie Mellon University 5000 Forbes Avenue Pittsburgh, PA 15213	https://csd.cmu.edu/academics/masters/mo-in-comp-iter-science	可以立刻send链接 需要在final ddl前提交letter	SOP Prepare a concise one or two page essay in PDF or Word format, using at least 10 pt. font size, that describes your primary areas of interest, your related experiences, and your objective in pursuing a graduate degree at Carnegie Mellon. For example, you might explain how advanced study in Computer Science fits into your future career ambitions. There are no right answers, and you do not need to have worked out your future plans in detail. When describing your interests, you should explain why you think they are important areas of study and why you are particularly well-suited to pursue them. We just want to see that you have-thought your purpose through. If your background is unusual, this is also the right place to explain it to us.	TOEFL Institution Code: 4256 TOEFL Department Code: 78 ✓✓	GRE Institution Code: 2074 GRE Department Code: 0402 ✓	Submit your current resume in PDF or Word format. Outline your education, research experience, work experience, publications, scholarships awarded, prizes and honors received, society memberships, and extracurricular activities. Note: Links embedded into text will not be readable due to security reasons. Please list any URL that you would like the admissions committee to see at the bottom of your document.	https://admissions.scs.cmu.edu/portal/apply_gr	
Carnegie Mellon University	Nov. 19th (Early), Dec. 10th (Final)	Created A... Sent RL link Submitted Received a...	Master of Computational Data Science (MCDS) ✓	Language Technologies Institute School of Computer Science Carnegie Mellon University 5000 Forbes Avenue Pittsburgh, PA 15213	https://liti.cmu.edu/academics/masters-programs/mc.html	可以立刻send链接 需要在final ddl前提交letter	SOP We are looking for strong, experience-based evidence that you can do well in our degree program and that you "fit" based on our areas of focus. For example, a description of a large software or research project, your involvement in the project, and the impact of the research is good evidence. An explanation of what drew your interest to the MCDS program and how it relates to your professional goals is also useful. You may also take this opportunity to explain any apparent weaknesses in your application. Although details regarding your personal interests and background can be helpful, they are not part of our admissions criteria and should not constitute the bulk of your statement of purpose. Most importantly, your statement of purpose should be written by you and provide an accurate representation of your experiences and goals.	TOEFL Institution Code: 4256 TOEFL Department Code: 78 ✓✓	GRE Institution Code: 2074 GRE Department Code: 0402 ✓	Submit your current resume in PDF or Word format. Outline your education, research experience, work experience, publications, scholarships awarded, prizes and honors received, society memberships, and extracurricular activities. Note: Links embedded into text will not be readable due to security reasons. Please list any URL that you would like the admissions committee to see at the bottom of your document.	https://admissions.scs.cmu.edu/portal/apply_gr	Prepare a 1-3 minute video that lets the admission committee know:
Carnegie Mellon University	Nov. 19th (Early), Dec. 10th (Final)	Created A... Sent RL link Submitted Received a...	Master of Science in Intelligent Information Systems (MIS) ✗	Language Technologies Institute School of Computer Science Carnegie Mellon University 5000 Forbes Avenue Pittsburgh, PA 15213	https://www.liti.cmu.edu/academics/masters-programs/mis.html	可以立刻send链接 需要在final ddl前提交letter	SOP Prepare a concise one or two page essay in PDF or Word format that describes your primary areas of interest, your related experiences, and your objective in pursuing a graduate degree at Carnegie Mellon. Your essay should include your name and be specific in describing your interests and motivations. When describing your interests, you should explain why you think they are important areas of study and why you are particularly well-suited to pursue them. You should describe any relevant education, research, commercial, government, or teaching experience. Our review committees in every program value applicants who display persistence and resilience in the face of challenges and adversity. Demonstrating a commitment to achieve, show concern for others and for the community.	TOEFL Institution Code: 4256 TOEFL Department Code: 78 ✓✓	GRE Institution Code: 2074 GRE Department Code: 0402 ✓	Submit your current resume in PDF or Word format. Outline your education, research experience, work experience, publications, scholarships awarded, prizes and honors received, society memberships, and extracurricular activities. Note: Links embedded into text will not be	https://admissions.scs.cmu.edu/portal/apply_gr	You will have 1-3 minutes to record a video of yourself answering a question that we will provide.

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申请材料

- TOEFL (CMU、UCLA、UCB、Gatech、Columbia、USC)
- GRE (CMU、Gatech):
 - 备考推荐: <https://bibiji.site/> 刷题
- CV: 1-2页, 有别于找工 Resume, 需补充 Leadership/Volunteer 等内容
- Video Essay:
 - 两种类型:
 - 自行录制 (CMU MCDS)
 - 限时口语作答 (CMU MSIN/MIIS, Columbia)
 - 准备:
 - 小红书搜面经, 根据题目准备通用素材: 个人经历、Why Grad School、Why Program
- >3 封推荐信
- SOP (Statement of purpose)
- PS (Personal Statement)

推荐信

- 项目通常要求 2-3 封, 但建议提前联系 4-6 位推荐人, 避免麻烦同一位老师提交过多推荐信。
- 建议安排每位推荐人提交 10 封左右, 尽量不要超过 15 封(除非很熟的关系)
- 我的准备(4封)
 - UM 科研导师
 - UM 毕设课程教授
 - UM 课程教授
 - SJTU 助教课程教授
- 我的优先级: Connection > Details > Title, 美国推荐人 > 国内推荐人

推荐信

关于联系推荐人：

- 未回复礼貌 follow up 一次;多次未回复就及时找下一位, 不要内耗
- 及时提供 CV、SOP 和相关经历总结, 帮助老师写出更具体的内容
- 为每位老师单独准备一个 Spreadsheet, 记录:
 - 项目及学校名称
 - 项目截止日期
 - 推荐信发送及提交状态
 - full address (部分教授可能需要)
- 最好一次性发送所有项目的推荐链接, 减少频繁邮件对老师的打扰
- 截止日期前提前检查提交状态;如需提醒, 附上清晰的待提交项目和截止日期

SOP/PS

SOP (Statement of Purpose) : Related Experience, Objective

PS (Personal Statement) : Diversity, 非学术, 主要体现个人

核心: 讲好自己的故事, 让经历服务于项目 Fit

- 文书不是简历的详细展开, 而是对经历的重新组织与取舍
- 一定要有一条清晰的主线, 避免简单堆砌科研、实习和项目经历
- 每段经历都应该回答同一个问题: 为什么你适合这个项目?

写作前

- 仔细阅读官网的文书要求
- 根据不同项目调整重点, 不要用同一篇文书简单替换学校名称

SOP/PS

写什么:建立完整的逻辑链条(<https://www.bilibili.com/video/av74437297/>)

1. 你从哪里来 | 学习动机

为什么选择这个专业?哪些经历促使你申请这个项目?

2. 你是谁 | 能力与准备

你具备哪些知识、能力和经历,能够胜任项目的学习?

3. 你要去哪里 | 学习与职业规划

你希望在项目中学习什么?项目如何帮助你实现未来目标?

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申请结果复盘

录取确实有玄学, 但也不是纯玄学

- 保底项目可能被拒, 彩票项目可能会中, 每年都会受到扩招、缩招和项目偏好的影响
- **不要过度参考上一届的录取结果**
- 但能控制的是:
 - 合理的 School List
 - 高质量的申请材料
 - 与项目的匹配度 (Fit)

申请后的几点感悟:

- 不要用别人的录取结果定义自己的 School List
- 不要为了“更稳”而牺牲项目匹配度
- 录取有随机性, 但经历、叙事和 Fit 才是你真正能掌控的

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申请心态

读研是路径, 不是终点

- 申请结果有很强的不确定性, **录取与否并不能完整衡量一个人的能力**
- 对以找工为目标的同学来说, **项目平台很重要, 但并不决定最终结果**
- 即使进入所谓的“保底项目”, 也依然有人能够拿到很好的工作 Offer
- 研究生项目真正提供的, 是更多的 **时间、资源、平台与求职身份**
- 最终决定求职结果的, 仍然是个人的能力积累、准备程度与执行力

祝大家申请季一切顺利～



Qianhui

美国



扫二维码，添加我为朋友。